
Computer Applications

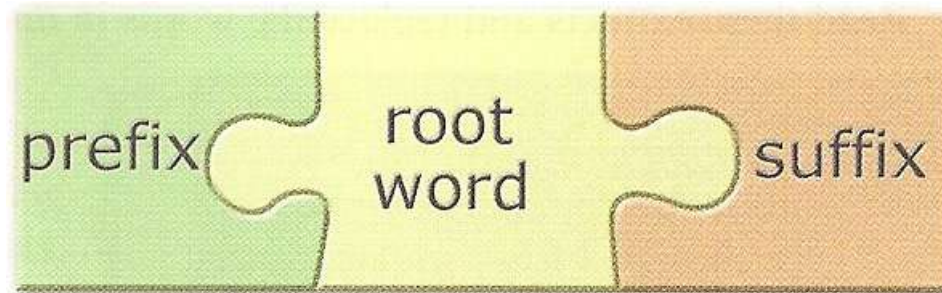
Ana Balula | Technical English

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Word formation

Word parts are like puzzle pieces.

We can form new words by using **prefixes** and **suffixes** (e.g. **micro** + process + **or**).



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Word formation

Prefixes come **before the root word**.

Common prefixes in IT:

Negative prefixes (non – non-volatile memory; un – unformatted disk)

Prefixes of location (trans (across) – data transmission; inter (between) – interconnected; intra (within) – intranet; extra (outside; in addition to) – extranet; tele (over a distance) – teleconferencing)

Prefixes of size (super (large; better) – supersite; semi (half; partly) – semiconductor); micro (small) – microbrowser; mega – megabyte; giga – gigabyte)

Verb prefixes (en – encrypt; up – update / upgrade / upload; de – decrypt / debug / decompress / defragment)

Other common prefixes: re- (rewritable; reboot) / e- (e-commerce; e-learning) / cyber- (cybercrime; cyberspace)

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Word formation

Suffixes come after the root word and change its class.

For example, by adding the suffix –er, the verb publish becomes the noun publisher. Suffixes can tell you if the word is a noun, adjective, verb or adverb.

Common suffixes in IT:

Suffixes for jobs (-er – manufacturer / webmaster; -eer – engineer; -or – animator / operator; -ant – consultant / assistant; -ian – technician / electrician)

Noun suffixes (-ion – compression; -ment – management; -ics – robotics; -ity – electricity; -ism – magnetism)

Adjective suffixes (-able – programmable; -ible – convertible; -ful – colourful; -less – colourless; -al – digital; -ic – magnetic)

Verb suffixes (-ize / -ise – synthesize; magnetize)

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